

Venice Summer School in Digital and Public Humanities

Venice, 6-10 July 2026

Activities with: Fabrizio Nevola (University of Exeter), Thursday 9 July

Urban Space, Geolocated Apps and Digital Public History: a Practical Demonstration of Hidden Venice

Location: [VeDPH Lab, Palazzo Malcanton Marcorà](#) · 2nd floor

• 15:30-18:00 Fabrizio Nevola (University of Exeter): **Urban Space, Geolocated Apps and Public History: a practical demonstration of Hidden Venice**

Workshop Activity:

Guidelines for the group activity

Please bring your phone, and headphones if you need them.

Download 'Hidden Venice' from AppStore or GooglePlay (Android/iOS).

(note content is available in Italian and English)

Short lecture and q&a then:

Part I

HistoryCity app trail Content Management System (CMS) demonstration, followed by on-site test and review of Hidden Venice trail: 'Boats, Bridges and Battles'.

You are free to use more of the app in your own time (there are 3 trails for Venice; 10 cities so far; also you might try Hidden Florence 3D for a different experience).

We will visit one or two sites as a group, with on-site discussion.

Part 2

You do not need to be an expert on Venice to do this task! We have limited time today, so this is only a demonstration. In groups of 4 or 5 – to be agreed in class before we go out – visit an allocated location and consider this site for 15 minutes.

Locations:

1. Campo Santa Margherita, Scuola dei Varottieri
2. Campo Santa Margherita, general view from the centre, by the well.
3. Campo Santa Margherita, bell tower of S Margherita church
4. Campo S Tomà, Scuola dei Calegheri
5. Campo S Tomà, general view from the centre, by the well.
6. Campo S Tomà, façade of S Tomà church

Things to consider when you are on site:

What can you see – what is the visual evidence that you want to comment on?

How might what you see help you think about what you wish to communicate to the listener?

Might there a particular historical issue that the object/site you have focused on allows you to discuss (think of the object as a “hook”)?

What can’t you see – this may require some creative thinking, but might also require some basic research?

Return to the classroom and sit in your groups for the final part of the class. When you return – or as you walk along – you may wish to do some basic research on the location to inform your discussion. However, don’t devote too much time to this.

Depending on the amount of time we have left we will:

Discuss each site in turn – each group to feedback a few key observations.

What sort of information have we been sharing?

Do you have a particular angle that you would like to foreground – and why?

What is the role of interpretation in research and “content creation”?

How might we input story-telling into this process, and how might we link together the sites selected?

What sort of additional information would you want to collect next?

Have you thought about your audience?

Bibliography:

Hidden Cities. Urban Space, Geolocated Apps and Public History in Early Modern Europe, Fabrizio Nevola, David Rosenthal, Nicholas Terpstra (eds.), Routledge: London, 2022. Open Access (free to read and download):

<https://www.taylorfrancis.com/books/oa-edit/10.4324/9781003172000/hidden-cities-fabrizio-nevola-david-rosenthal-nicholas-terpstra>

Fabrizio Nevola, ‘Modern technology is history’s ally, not its enemy’, 9 April 2022. Short article in the Times Higher: <https://www.timeshighereducation.com/blog/modern-technology-historys-ally-not-its-enemy>

Fabrizio Nevola and David Rosenthal, ‘Mobile media and urban memory: the *HistoryCity* project’, in *Advances in Cultural Tourism Research: Cultural & Creative Tourism as a Driver for Sustainable Development*, Marinos Ioannides et al. eds., Springer Nature Computer Science book series, 2026, pp. 131-43

https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-3-032-22974-8_10